



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Ordo Amoris Classical Academy
School Website: <https://ordoamorisclassical.com/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Ordo Amoris Classical Academy (Fairhope, AL 36532) presents a strong, textually rich embodiment of Classical Christian education. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize a classical framework (Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric), a Great Books-oriented curriculum, and a formation-focused mission centered on virtue, wisdom, and a God-centered life. The school climate emphasizes liturgical/community practices (hymn singing, prayers, Scripture-rooted identity), close teacher mentorship, and robust parental partnership. Evidence across the site points to a K–12 program with small class sizes, a living curriculum model, and explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in the upper grades. Taken together, the school earns a CLASSICAL rating across all six rubric categories, with a consistent alignment to the six essential elements of classical education documented in the knowledge base. See category-by-category breakdown below for category-specific keyword analyses and justification. Citations draw from the school's public pages and the Firecrawl-derived content.

- Core mission and approach: "As an independent, private, classical Christian school ... rooted in Scripture & the classical tradition" and the explicit aim to form minds and character through a classical Christian framework.
- Curriculum and pedagogy: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin recitations, Great Books emphasis, and a shift to Socratic/seminar-style upper-division work.
- History, literature, and culture: Great Books lists and recommended-reading materials, with Shakespeare and other classics cited in sample curricula.
- Faculty and mentorship: Faculty pages and profiles illustrating teacher leadership and mentorship as central to the curriculum (the "living curriculum").
- Parents and community: Explicit partnership with Christian families, co-laboring with parents, and ongoing engagement through events and communications.

Overall classification per category: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence The school explicitly positions itself as a classical Christian institution rooted in Scripture, with language that frames virtue and formation within a Christian framework. Texts emphasize partnering with Christian families, Scriptural grounding, and a formation-driven mission. Notable elements include: "classical Christian school," "rooted in Scripture," "gospel," and Coram Deo-style language in graduate expectations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christian, Scripture, gospel, theology, Coram Deo, liturgical/communal practices (hymn singing, prayers), fellowship with church culture, and prayers for the school community. These align with Positive Keywords for Religious/Metaphysical Foundations (Grounded in Theology; Liturgical/Communal Practices; transcendental realism implied by virtue formation).

- Negative keywords present: none tied to a secular or non-religious framing; no indication of secular or non-theological orientation on public pages. (Negative indicators in this domain would reflect a secular or non-theological approach, which is not evidenced here.)

Why this rating The material consistently locates education within a Christian theological framework, with explicit references to gospel, Scripture, and liturgical/community practices, underpinning transcendental moral realism as part of the school's foundation. The public materials demonstrate theological grounding and liturgical-communal orientation, supporting a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence The school's stated purpose centers on virtue formation and human excellence, rather than mere job preparation. Public materials articulate formation "to love learning, pursue virtue in all of life, and glorify God," and portrait statements emphasize virtue, wisdom, truth, and beauty as ultimate ends. The Portrait of a Graduate lists virtues including gospel understanding, prayer, service, and eloquence, signaling formation as the core aim.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, Coram Deo, gospel, glorify God, humane excellence. These map to Positive Keywords for Goal/Purpose as articulated in the classical framework.

- Negative keywords present: none observed (no explicit job-or-market-first framing or neutral values analysis on public pages).

Why this rating Formation (virtue, wisdom, beauty) and the explicit aim to form human character rather than simply prepare for work align with the classical ideal of purpose and goal. The school consistently frames education as a formation of character and intellect in a theologically integrated, virtue-centered way, thus CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence Curriculum emphasis is squarely on liberal arts through the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and the cultivation of wonder. Evidence includes explicit reference to grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin recitations, Great Books, and a "Recommended Book List" to guide classical reading. History is treated as a core through-line (not as "social studies"). The site also notes the Great Conversation and the use of classical texts across grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin recitations, historical consciousness, Western tradition, sacred/traditional texts, memory, wonder, classical canon. These correspond with Positive Keywords for Curriculum (liberal arts, Great Books, historic/cultural transmission, etc.).

- Negative keywords present: none related to a secular or non-traditional curriculum approach.

Why this rating The presence of Trivium-based structure, Great Books, and a history-centered, wonder-infused curriculum places the school firmly in CLASSICAL for Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence Pedagogy at Ordo Amoris includes both contemplative elements and rigorous engagement. Lower school features singing/chanting with regular review to deepen memory and delight; upper school features Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetorical training. The public materials also reference small class sizes and the "living curriculum" concept. In addition, a documented section describes the Socratic method and rhetoric as central to high-level learning. The presence of a pedagogy that blends contemplative/restful elements with rigorous, dialogic inquiry aligns with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: singing/chanting, contemplative/restful learning, memory/Schol  like memory practices, Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric, public speaking, living curriculum, classical pedagogy terms.

- Negative keywords present: none indicating a non-classical or purely rote approach; no evidence of modern, value-neutral, or purely standardized-pacing pedagogy in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating The blend of Socratic inquiry in upper grades, emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking, and lower-school chanting/memory practices aligns with classical pedagogy expectations, supporting a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence Faculty structure and role are depicted as mentors and living curriculum, with named roles (Founder/Head of School, Academic Dean, individual teachers) and a culture of mentorship and virtue. The faculty are described as models of virtue and the core of the school, with public profiles and statements of mentorship, professional background, and a portrait of the teacher's role in forming students. The school's statements about small class sizes and teacher-led formation further reinforce the classical faculty model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, professional, virtue, wisdom, mentorship, formation through example, reverence, responsibility, professionalism, faith and reason.

- Negative keywords present: none observed that would suggest a non-classical faculty model.

Why this rating Public-facing content emphasizes teachers as moral exemplars and the living curriculum, with explicit mentorship and character formation. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence The school explicitly frames itself as partnering with Christian families, operating "in loco parentis," and fostering co-teaching relationships with parents. Community engagement includes events and communications (e.g., Growing In Gratitude Gala, annual giving, Prayers for Ordo Amoris) and openness to visits and parent involvement. The site also communicates that both parents' and families' active participation is part of the school's model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teaching with parents, plan a visit, Prayers for Ordo Amoris, Growing In Gratitude Gala, annual giving, open visits, parental involvement in reading and discussions (as part of a classical program). - Negative keywords present: none observed in public content that would indicate poor parental involvement or sequestered governance; the negative indicators in the Six Elements document are not evidenced on the school's site.

Why this rating A robust, clearly articulated partnership with parents and families, coupled with active community engagement and open invitation for involvement, corresponds with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment

Overall, Ordo Amoris Classical Academy Alabama (Fairhope, AL) demonstrates a full CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; School Purpose and Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; and Parents & Community. The publicly visible materials consistently reflect the classical framework (Trivium, Great Books, wonder), the integration of theology and liturgical/community life, formation-centric aims, mentorship-driven faculty, and active parental partnership.

- Classical indicators present across all six categories, with clear alignment to the Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements document (e.g., Great Books, Trivium, theology/scripture, virtue formation, Socratic pedagogy, living curriculum, parent partnership). See cited materials above.

What would move the needle

Not applicable, as the school's aggregate classification is CLASSICAL across all categories. No category requires a needle-moving adjustment to reach CLASSICAL; the school already aligns with the classical education rubric in this evaluation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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